# USING LLMs TO IMPROVE YOUR ARCHIVES

FROM STORY ARCHIVES TO BEAT BOOK

# INTRODUCTION

- A beat book is a guide that helps a reporter get acquainted with a new beat or topic based on previously published stories.

- Requirements :
  - Story archives in a machine-readable format (JSON file)
  - Access to Github (Codespace & Copilot)
  - Access to LLMs (commercial and open-source models)

# FROM JSON FILE TO BEAT BOOK


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Page: 1 | Section: News \n \n 472\n Words \n\n Read News Document\n\n EASTON - Susan Delean-Botkin has stepped down from the Talbot County Board of Education since being appointed
an Oxford Commissioner.In an interview, Delean-Botkin said she made the decision to leave the school board due to personal reasons and her new role in Oxford's local
government.Delean-Botkin said she already misses being on the Board of Education \"tremendously.\" \"School board was a fabulous experience,\" she said. \"Interacting with really
great administrators, wonderful teachers, fantastic students, working with the board members, all of whom were really top quality people to work with.\" Delean-Botkin was sworn into
the Talbot County Board of Education District 5 seat in January 2017. She was elected president of the board in December 2020 and held the role through 2022.Moving forward, Delean-
Botkin said she hopes the Board of Education continues to maintain the county's high graduation rate and low dropout rate, expand its Career and Technical Education completer
courses and implement the Blueprint for Maryland's Future, a statewide plan to increase public education funding, improve student outcomes and improve the quality of public
education.\"The other big thing that we're very proud of is having as many students as wish to go ahead and take the Advanced Placement classes and exams,\" Delean-Botkin said.At a
July 19 Talbot County Board of Education meeting, President Emily Jackson said the board wishes Delean-Botkin the best of luck.\"We will miss her words of wisdom and her guidance,\"
Jackson said.Talbot County Public Schools Executive Assistant Charlene Gould said in an email that the governor's office has been notified of the vacancy and will appoint a new
board member to fill Delean-Botkin's seat until elections in November 2024.She said interested candidates can submit an application to the Governor's Appointments Office.In June,
Commissioners Tom Costigan and Jimmy Jaramillo appointed Delean-Botkin to fill Commissioner Brian Wells' seat.Wells resigned at the June 27 Commissioners of Oxford meeting. He said
he was resigning because he was moving to Easton.Before being appointed, Delean-Botkin ran against and lost to now Commissioner Katrina Greer. Greer took the seat of Jaramillo, who
did not seek reelection.Delean-Botkin said her new role as Oxford commissioner is a \"challenging\" one.\"I think what we have to look at is, Oxford a town of about 600 folks,\" she
said.\"Three sides are surrounded by water, so we have limits on growth. People tend to want to move to Oxford because of the quality of life.Majority of people that I talk to do
not want to see many things change. They want to maintain the integrity of the town.\" \n \n Caption: PHOTO BY MAGGIE TROVATO\n \nSusan Delean-Botkin has resigned from the Talbot
County Board of Education. \n \n Memo: \"The other big thing that we're very proud of is having as many students as wish to go ahead and take the Advanced Placement classes and
exams.\" - Susan Delean-Botkin \n\n © Copyright © 2023 Star Democrat, Chesapeake Publishing Group (Adams Publishing/APGMedia). All rights reserved.",
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# Education Beat Book - Easton Star-Democrat

## Caroline County, Maryland

This guide covers the education beat in Caroline County, Maryland, focusing on Caroline County Public Schools (CCPS), early childhood services, and local governance that affects students and families.

Caroline County is a rural county on Maryland's Eastern Shore. CCPS serves about 5,676 students in 10 schools across pre-K through grade 12 and employs more than 1,100 staff.

## The system at a glance: Caroline County Public Schools (CCPS)

CCPS is the countywide public school district serving Denton, Federalsburg, Greensboro, Ridgely, Preston, and surrounding communities. The district's core storylines tend to cluster around facilities planning, staffing and recruiting, student supports, and the annual budget cycle with county government.

Keep a running list of the district's standing committees and recurring public meetings. Facilities and capital planning can move on a different calendar than the operating budget and can involve separate state and local approval steps.

CCPS leadership messaging in 2025 emphasized system identity and recruitment. Superintendent Derek Simmons used the motto "One Family — One Vision" in staff-facing remarks, and central office leaders described the district as a small system with countywide reach.

## Governance and decision points

The Caroline County Board of Education sets policy, approves contracts, and votes on major capital projects such as school construction and site selection. The superintendent and central office manage day-to-day operations and present budget and staffing plans for board action.

Board membership can change abruptly and can reshape internal dynamics. Board member Donna DiGiacomo resigned in March 2024 after objecting to Superintendent Derek Simmons' use of the term "minions" to describe employees during a public meeting. Her term had been set to expire in 2027; track the vacancy process, appointment or election plans, and how the board manages transitions in closed session and public votes.

# Eastern Shore Education

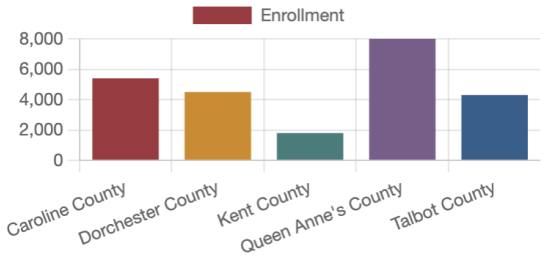
To exit full screen, press and hold esc

CAROLINE • DORCHESTER • KENT • QUEEN ANNE'S • TALBOT

OVERVIEW DASHBOARD | COUNTY PROFILES | RECENT STORIES | STORY ARCHIVE | KEY SOURCES | QUOTE DATABASE

## Overview Dashboard

### Enrollment by County

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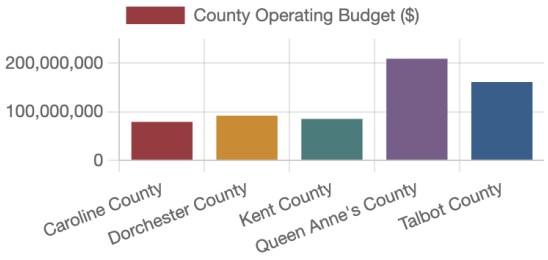


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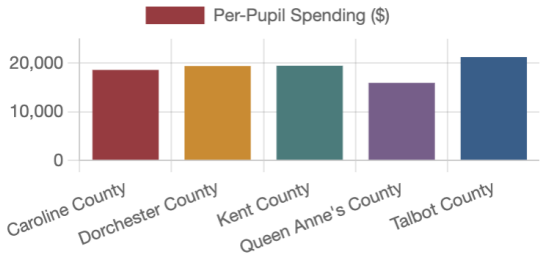


### Topline Summary

The Eastern Shore region exhibits profound differences in local revenue capacity, student demographics, and per-pupil spending. Queen Anne's leads in local contributions, while Caroline and Dorchester depend heavily on Blueprint state aid. Enrollment trends diverge sharply, as do capital needs and staffing pressures.

# TWO BROAD STAGES

- METADATA EXTRACTION (open-source llms)
- BEAT BOOK GENERATION (commercial llms)

# METADATA EXTRACTION

- First thing to consider: Final output
- Generate python script using Github Copilot
- Extract data using open-source LLMs
- Verification

# BEAT BOOK GENERATION

- Generate Python script for beat book production using Copilot
- Create beat book using commercial model
- Refine output